“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 3

The Description of the Acceptance of Sannyāsa and the Feast in Advaita’s House

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 After accepting sannyāsa, Gaura, overflowing with love, longed to go to Vṛndāvana; but, lost to the outer world, He wandered through Rāḍha. Then He came to Śāntipura and rejoiced there with His devotees. I bow down to Him.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 At the close of His twenty-fourth year, in the bright fortnight of the month of Māgha, the Lord accepted *sannyāsa*.[3]

4 After accepting sannyāsa, absorbed in love, He set out for Vṛndāvana, but for three days He wandered in the land of Rāḍha.[4]

5 Reciting this verse in the rapture of His feelings, the Lord wandered on and purified the whole land of Rāḍha:

6 “I shall take up this devotion to the Supreme Self (*parātma-niṣṭhā*), which the great souls of old embraced; and by service to the feet of

Mukunda alone I shall cross the darkness whose far shore is so hard to reach." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.23.57)[5]

7 The Lord said, "How excellent are this mendicant's words! He has firmly resolved on the vow of serving Mukunda.

8 The dress of renunciation is worn only for the sake of devotion to the Supreme Self, and it is service to Mukunda that delivers one from saṁsāra.[6]

9 I have taken that dress; now I shall go to Vṛndāvana and serve Kṛṣṇa, settled in solitude."

10 Saying this, the Lord went on, showing the signs of love's madness. He had no sense of direction and did not know whether it was night or day.

11 Nityānanda, Ācāryaratna and Mukunda — these three followed close behind the Lord.

12 Whoever saw the Lord cried out "Hari!", overcome with love, and all their sorrow and grief were cut away.

13 All the cowherd boys, on seeing the Lord, called out loudly, "Hari! Hari!"

14 Hearing this, Gaurahari went up to them, placed His hand on each one's head and said, "Say it! Say it!"

15 He praised them all: "You are fortunate! You have made My life complete by letting Me hear the name of Hari."

16 Meanwhile Ṭhākura Nityānanda gathered the boys in secret and, having made up a fitting tale, taught them all what to say:[7]

17 “When the Lord asks you the way to Vṛndāvana, show Him the path along the bank of the Gaṅgā.”

18 Then the Lord asked, “Listen, children! Tell Me, which way should I take to Vṛndāvana?”

19 The children showed Him the path along the bank of the Gaṅgā, and the Lord, absorbed in rapture, went that way.[8]

20 Nityānanda Gosāñi said to Ācāryaratna, “Go quickly to Advaita Ācārya.[9]

21 I shall bring the Lord to His house. Let Him wait ready on the bank with a boat.

22 Then go to Navadvīpa and come back with Mother Śacī and the other devotees.”[10]

23 Having sent him off, the great-hearted Nityānanda came before Mahāprabhu and made Himself known.

24 The Lord said, “Śrīpāda, where are You going?” Śrīpāda answered, “I am going with You to Vṛndāvana.”

25 The Lord asked, “How far is Vṛndāvana?” Nityānanda replied, “Look, here is the Yamunā!”

26 With these words He brought Mahāprabhu to the Gaṅgā, and in His rapture the Lord saw the Gaṅgā as the Yamunā.[11]

27 “Oh, what fortune! I have seen the Yamunā!” Saying this, He began to sing her praises:

28 “She is ever the object of the supreme love of Nanda’s son, the sun of consciousness and bliss. Her body is Brahman become water; she cuts away all sins and brings good to the world. May the daughter of the Sun purify our bodies!” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 5.13)[12]

29 Saying this, He bowed down and bathed in the Gaṅgā. He had only a single *kaupīna* and no other cloth.

30 Just then Ācārya Gosāñi arrived by boat, bringing a new *kaupīna* and outer cloth.

31 The Ācārya came before Him, bowed down and stood waiting. At the sight of the Ācārya the Lord was puzzled at heart, and He said:[13]

32 “You are Ācārya Gosāñi, aren’t You? Why have You come here? How did You know that I was in Vṛndāvana?”

33 The Ācārya said, “Wherever You are, that is Vṛndāvana. It is My good fortune that You have come to the bank of the Gaṅgā.”

34 The Lord said, “Nityānanda has deceived Me! He brought Me to the Gaṅgā and told Me it was the Yamunā.”[14]

35 The Ācārya said, “Śrīpāda’s words are not false. Just now You did bathe in the Yamunā.

36 Here the Yamunā flows in the Gaṅgā, and the two run as one stream: on the west flows the Yamunā, on the east the Gaṅgā.

37 The Yamunā flows in the western stream, and that is where You bathed. Now take off Your wet *kaupīna* and put on a dry one.

38 Absorbed in love, You have been fasting for three days. Today take Your alms in My house; come home with Me.

39 I have cooked just a handful of rice and made some plain vegetables, dāl and greens."[15]

40 Saying this, He seated the Lord in the boat and took Him to His own house, where, joyful at heart, He washed the Lord's feet.

41 The Ācārya's wife had done the cooking beforehand, and the Ācārya Himself offered the food to Viṣṇu.[16]

42 The food was set out in three equal portions, and Kṛṣṇa's offering was placed on a metal plate.[17]

43 The other two portions were beautifully arranged on whole leaves of the *battiśā-āṭhiyā* banana.[18]

44 In the middle of each was a heap of fine *śāli* rice soaked in yellow ghee, and all around it stood leaf cups of vegetables and mung dāl.

45 There was *sārdraka*, various kinds of *vāstuka* greens, *paṭola*, pumpkin with *baḍi*, and *mānakacu*.[19]

46 All the fruits and roots, seasoned with *cai*, black pepper and *sukhta*, became five kinds of bitter and pungent dishes that put nectar to shame.[20]

47 There was eggplant fried with tender *nim* leaves, *paṭola* fried with *phula-baḍi*, and pumpkin *mānacāki*.

48 There was coconut pulp, fresh curd (*chānā*) sweetened with sugar, a *ghaṇṭa* of banana flowers and pumpkin cooked in milk — all in

abundance.

49 There were sweet-and-sour *baḍās* and five or six sour dishes. Every vegetable dish known in the world was made.[21]

50 There were *baḍās* of mung and of urad, sweet banana *baḍās*, *kṣīrapulī*, coconut, and every kind of cake one could wish for.[22]

51 The cups made of *battiśā-āṭhiyā* banana leaves were very large and strong, so that they did not tip or wobble.

52 Around each of the three offerings they set fifty such cups filled with vegetables.

53 Sweet rice with ghee filled new earthen pots, and thickened milk was set out in three vessels.

54 There was flat rice with banana in milk, and milk *laklakī*. I cannot describe all that they made.[23]

55 On both sides stood earthen pots filled with *cāp̃ā* bananas, yogurt and *sandeśa* — I cannot describe it all.

56 On top of the rice and vegetables they placed tulasī buds, and three water pots were filled with scented water.[24]

57 There were three white seats covered with cloth. The Ācārya fed Kṛṣṇa's portion to Kṛṣṇa Himself.[25]

58 When it was time for ārati, the Ācārya called the two Lords, and everyone came with Them to see it.

59 After the ārati, Kṛṣṇa was laid down to rest, and then the Ācārya came and made a request to the Lord:

60 “Please, Lord, come into the house.” Then the two Brothers went in to take Their meal.

61 The two Lords called Mukunda and Haridāsa, but the two of them, with joined palms, began to speak.

62 Mukunda said, “Some of my duties are not yet finished. I shall take prasāda later; You go inside.”

63 Haridāsa said, “I am most sinful and lowly. Later I shall eat a handful outside.”

64 The Ācārya took the two Lords into the inner room. Seeing the prasāda, the Lord felt joy in His heart.

65 “Whoever feeds Kṛṣṇa such food — birth after birth I would hold his feet upon My head.”

66 The Lord took all three portions to be food already offered to Kṛṣṇa, for He did not know what the Ācārya had in mind.[26]

67 “You too sit down and eat,” said the Lord. “I shall serve,” replied the Ācārya.[27]

68 The Lord said, “Where shall I sit? Bring two more leaves, and put just a little rice and vegetables on them.”[28]

69 “Both of You, sit on these seats,” said the Ācārya, and He took Them by the hand and seated Them.

70 The Lord said, “Such fare is not fit food for a sannyāsī. If he eats this, how will he restrain his senses?”[29]

71 The Ācārya said, “Stop hiding who You are. I know the secret of Your sannyāsa.[30]

72 Eat, and stop Your clever talk.” “I cannot eat so much,” said the Lord.

73 The Ācārya said, “Eat without pretence. If You cannot eat it all, the rest can stay.”[31]

74 The Lord said, “I shall not be able to eat so much, and it is not a sannyāsī’s dharma to leave remnants.”[32]

75 The Ācārya said, “In Nīlācala You eat fifty-four times, and each time You eat hundreds and hundreds of loads of food.

76 What three people eat is a single mouthful for You. By that reckoning this food is not even five mouthfuls.

77 By My good fortune You have come to My house. Give up Your cleverness, Lord, and eat.”

78 Saying this, He poured water on the hands of the two Gosāñis, and with a smile the two of Them began to eat.

79 Nityānanda said, “I have fasted for three days, and I had great hope of breaking My fast today.

80 But today, by the Ācārya’s invitation, it has turned into a fast: this mouthful of food has not filled even half My belly.”

81 The Ācārya said, “You are a pilgrim sannyāsī: sometimes You eat fruits and roots, sometimes You fast.[33]

82 Be satisfied with the handful of food You have received in a poor brāhmaṇa’s house, and give up Your greed.”

83 Nityānanda said, “Since You invited Me, You must give Me as much as I eat.”

84 Hearing Nityānanda’s words, Ṭhākura Advaita answered Him fondly:

85 “You are a fallen avadhūta! You took sannyāsa just to fill Your belly — to punish brāhmaṇas, I think.[34]

86 You can eat ten or twenty *māns* of rice. Where shall I, a poor brāhmaṇa, get that much?[35]

87 Eat the handful of food You have been given and get up. Don’t act like a madman, and don’t scatter Your leftovers about!”

88 In this way They ate, joking and laughing. The Lord would eat half of each vegetable dish and leave the rest.

89 The Ācārya would fill that dish again, and so He served the vegetables again and again.

90 Filling the cup with vegetables, He would entreat the Lord to eat. The Lord said, “How much more am I to eat?”

91 The Ācārya said, “Do not leave what I have already given You. Of what I give You now, eat half.”

92 With many efforts and humble pleas the Ācārya fed the Lord, and the Lord fulfilled His wish.

93 Nityānanda said, “My belly is not full! Take it away — I have not eaten any of Your food.”

94 Saying this, He took up a handful of rice and flung it down before Him, as if in anger.

95 A few grains of rice struck the Ācārya’s body, and with the rice still on Him He danced about in delight.[36]

96 “The leftovers of the avadhūta have touched My body! In this way He has made Me supremely pure.[37]

97 I invited You, and I have reaped the fruit of it! You have no caste or family — You are a madman by nature.[38]

98 To make Me just like You, You threw Your leftovers at Me, without any fear that I am a brāhmaṇa.”[39]

99 Nityānanda said, “This is Kṛṣṇa’s prasāda! By calling it ‘leftovers’ You have committed an offence.[40]

100 If You feed a hundred sannyāsīs, then this offence will be cancelled.”

101 The Ācārya said, “I shall never again invite a sannyāsī! A sannyāsī has ruined all My *smṛti-dharma*.”[41]

102 Saying this, He had the two Lords rinse Their hands and mouths, and then laid Them down to rest on a fine bed.

103 He gave Them cloves and cardamom seeds with tulasī buds as a fragrant mouth-freshener.

104 He anointed Their bodies with fragrant sandalwood paste, and brought garlands of sweet-scented flowers and placed them on Their chests.

105 The Ācārya wished to massage the Lord's feet, but the Lord, abashed, said:

106 "You have made Me dance a great deal; now stop making Me dance. Go and eat with Mukunda and Haridāsa."[42]

107 Then the Ācārya took the two of them with Him and ate, as He had wished in His heart.

108 Hearing that the Lord had come, the people of Śāntipura came to see His feet.

109 The people joyfully called out "Hari! Hari!", and seeing the Lord's beauty, they were struck with wonder.

110 The radiance of His golden body outshone the sun, and over it shimmered the glow of His cloth, red as the dawn.

111 People kept coming and going without end, and in that throng the day came to its close.[43]

112 In the evening the Ācārya began saṅkīrtana; He danced, and the Lord looked on.

113 Nityānanda Gosāñi moved along with the Ācārya, holding Him, and behind them Haridāsa danced for joy.

114 “What shall I tell you, My friend? There is no limit to My bliss today: at long last Mādhava is in My house.”[44]

115 The Ācārya had this song sung and danced for joy, with sweat and trembling, hair standing on end, tears, cries of “huṁ” and thunderous roars.[45]

116 Whirling round and round, now and then He would clasp the Lord’s feet, and holding them He would say:

117 “For many days You eluded Me and led Me about with Your tricks. Now I have caught You in My house, and I shall bind You and keep You here.”

118 Saying this, the Ācārya danced in bliss, and for a whole prahara of the night He held saṅkīrtana.

119 Love’s longing seized the Lord, for Kṛṣṇa was not with Him, and in separation the burning waves of prema rose ever higher.[46]

120 Overwhelmed, the Lord fell to the ground. Seeing this, the Ācārya stopped His dance.

121 Mukunda knew the Lord’s heart well, and he began to sing a song suited to His mood.

122 The Ācārya raised the Lord up to dance, but on hearing the song the Lord could not hold His body steady.

123 Tears, trembling, hair standing on end, sweat and a faltering voice appeared in Him. One moment He rose, the next He fell, and at times He wept.

124 “Alas, My friend, dear to Me as life! What has become of Me! The poison of love for Kānu consumes My body and mind.[47]

125 Night and day My heart burns, and I find no relief. Wherever I could find Kānu, there I would fly.”

126 Mukunda sang this song in a sweet and lovely voice, and as the Lord listened, His heart was wrung with anguish.

127 Despondency, dejection, joy, restlessness, pride and humility — an army of feelings waged war on the Lord.[48]

128 Battered by the blows of these feelings, the Lord fell to the ground, and there was no breath in His body.

129 Seeing this, all the devotees grew anxious. Then suddenly the Lord rose with a roar.

130 “Chant! Chant!” He cried, and danced, overwhelmed with bliss. The mighty waves of His feelings were beyond understanding.

131 Nityānanda moved beside the Lord, holding Him, while the Ācārya and Haridāsa followed behind, dancing.

132 In this way the Lord danced blissfully for a prahara, now glad, now downcast, borne on the waves of His feelings.

133 After three days of fasting the Lord had eaten, and now the wild, leaping dance wearied Him.

134 Yet, absorbed in love, He did not feel His weariness. Then Nityānanda took hold of Mahāprabhu and stopped Him.

135 Ācārya Gosāñi brought the kīrtana to a close, and after serving the Lord in many ways, He had Him lie down to rest.

136 In this way, for ten days, the Ācārya served the Lord with feasts and kīrtana, day after day without change.

137 In the morning Ācāryaratna came with the devotees, bringing Śacīmātā in a palanquin.[49]

138 All the people of the town of Nadīyā came — women, children and old men — and the crowd grew vast.

139 When the Lord had finished His morning duties and was singing the holy name in saṅkīrtana, they arrived at Advaita's house with Śacīmātā.

140 The Lord fell flat like a rod before Śacī, and she lifted Him onto her lap and began to weep.

141 At the sight of each other both were overwhelmed, and seeing no hair on His head, Śacī was stricken with grief.

142 She wiped His body, kissed His face and gazed at Him, but she could not see Him, for tears filled her eyes.

143 Weeping, Śacī said, "My child Nimāi, do not be cruel like Viśvarūpa.

144 After he became a sannyāsī, he never let me see him again. If You do the same, it will be my death."

145 The Lord replied in tears, "Listen, My mother. This body is yours; there is nothing of Mine in it.[50]

146 You gave birth to this body and nurtured it. Even in millions of births I could not repay My debt to you.

147 Whether I took sannyāsa knowingly or unknowingly, I shall never be indifferent to you.

148 Wherever you tell Me to stay, there I shall stay, and whatever you order, that I shall do.”

149 Saying this, He bowed down to her again and again, and His mother, delighted, took Him on her lap time after time.

150 Then the Ācārya took Śacī inside, and the Lord hastened to meet the devotees.

151 The Lord met all the devotees one by one, looking into each one’s face and embracing him tightly.

152 Though the devotees grieved to see no hair on His head, still, as they beheld His beauty, they felt great joy.[51]

153 Śrīvāsa, Rāmāi, Vidyānidhi, Gadādhara, Gaṅgādāsa, Vakreśvara, Murāri, Śuklāmbara,

154 Buddhimanta Khān, Nandana, Śrīdhara, Vijaya, Vāsudeva, Dāmodara, Mukunda, Sañjaya —

155 how many of the people of Navadvīpa can I name? The Lord met them all, smiling, with a glance full of mercy.

156 Everyone danced in bliss, calling “Hari! Hari!”, and the Ācārya’s house became the city of Śrī Vaikuṇṭha.[52]

157 People came from many villages and from Navadvīpa to see Mahāprabhu.[53]

158 To all of them Ācārya Gosāñi gave lodging, food and drink, and for many days He provided for them.

159 The Ācārya's storehouse was inexhaustible and never grew less: however much He spent, as much again was there.

160 From that day on Śacī did the cooking, and the Lord ate with the devotees.

161 By day the Ācārya's joy was to behold the Lord; at night the people watched the Lord's dancing and kīrtana.

162 As He sang kīrtana, every bhāva arose in the Lord: stupor, trembling, hair standing on end, tears, a faltering voice and loss of consciousness (*pralaya*).[54]

163 Again and again the Lord fell, dashing Himself to the ground, and seeing this, Śacīmātā spoke, weeping.

164 "I fear Nimāi's body has been shattered!" Crying out "Alas!", she begged this boon of Viṣṇu:

165 "O Nārāyaṇa, for whatever service I have done You since my childhood, give me this as its fruit:[55]

166 whenever Nimāi falls upon the ground, let no pain touch His body."

167 In this way Śacīdevī was overwhelmed with motherly love and shaken by joy, fear and humility.

168 All the Lord's brāhmaṇa devotees, headed by Śrīvāsa, wished to invite Him to a meal.

169 At this Śacī entreated them all: "Where will I ever see Nimāi again?

170 You will be able to meet Him elsewhere, but for me, unfortunate as I am, there is only this chance to see Him.

171 As long as Nimāi stays in the Ācārya's house, let me alone feed Him. I beg this gift from you all."

172 Hearing this, the devotees bowed down and said, "Whatever the mother wishes, we all accept."

173 Seeing His mother's eagerness, the Lord was moved. He gathered the devotees together and spoke to them:

174 "Without your permission I set out for Vṛndāvana, but I could not get there: an obstacle turned Me back.

175 Although I took sannyāsa so suddenly, I shall never become indifferent to you.

176 As long as I live I shall not forsake you, nor shall I be able to forsake My mother.

177 But it is not a sannyāsī's dharma, once he has taken sannyāsa, to stay at his birthplace with his family.[56]

178 So tell Me a plan by which both dharmas may be kept and no one may find fault with Me."[57]

179 Hearing these sweet words of the Lord, the Ācārya and the others went to Śacī.

180 They told her all that the Lord had asked, and hearing it, Śacī, the mother of the world, said:

181 “If He stays here, I shall be happy; but if He is blamed, I shall be sorrowful.[58]

182 So this plan seems good to me: if He stays in Nīlācala, both aims will be served.

183 Nīlācala and Navadvīpa are like two homes of one family. People are always going back and forth, and I shall constantly have news of Him.

184 All of you can go there and come back, and at times He will come to bathe in the Gaṅgā.

185 I do not count my own sorrow or happiness. Whatever makes Him happy, that I take as my own happiness.”[59]

186 The devotees praised her: “Mother, your words are like a command of the Vedas.”

187 They went and told the Lord, and when He heard it, His heart was filled with joy.

188 Showing honour to all the devotees, the residents of Navadvīpa and all the rest, He spoke to them:

189 “You are all My dearest friends, and I beg this of you all as alms — grant it to Me:

190 Go home and always perform saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa — chant Kṛṣṇa's name, speak of Kṛṣṇa and worship Kṛṣṇa.

191 Give Me leave to go to Nīlācala. From time to time I shall come back and let you see Me."

192 Saying this, the Lord smiled gently at everyone and bade them farewell with due honour.

193 When He had bidden them all farewell, the Lord made up His mind to set out. Then Haridāsa, weeping, spoke piteously:

194 "You will go to Nīlācala — but what will become of me? I have no power to go there.[60]

195 Lowly as I am, I shall not be able to see You. How shall I keep this sinful life?"

196 The Lord said, "Restrain your humility; it troubles My heart.

197 For your sake I shall plead with Jagannātha, and I shall take you with Me to Śrī Puruṣottama."[61]

198 Then the Ācārya said humbly, "Be merciful and stay a few more days."

199 The Lord would not go against the Ācārya's words. He stayed on in Advaita's house and put off His departure.

200 The Ācārya, Śacī and all the devotees were delighted, and every day He held a grand festival.

201 By day there was the relish of talks about Kṛṣṇa with the devotees, and at night a great festival of joyous saṅkīrtana.

202 Śacī cooked with delight, and the Lord ate happily with the devotees.

203 With the Lord's coming, the Ācārya's faith and devotion, His house, His property and His wealth all bore their fruit.[62]

204 Śacī's bliss grew as she saw her son's face, and by feeding Him she made her own happiness complete.

205 In this way the devotees, gathered in Advaita's house, spent several days in great festivity.

206 Then one day the Lord said to all the devotees, "Go back now, all of you, to your own homes.

207 Once home, all of you perform saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa, and you will meet Me again.

208 Sometimes you will come to Nīlādri, and sometimes I shall come to bathe in the Gaṅgā."

209 Nityānanda Gosāñi, Jagadānanda Paṇḍita, Dāmodara Paṇḍita and Mukunda Datta —

210 the Ācārya sent these four with the Lord. The Lord consoled His mother and bowed at her feet.

211 He walked around her in reverence and departed, and in the Ācārya's house a cry of weeping arose.

212 Free of all worldly ties, the Lord walked swiftly away, and the Ācārya followed Him, weeping as He went.[63]

213 After going some distance, the Lord joined His palms and spoke sweet, consoling words to the Ācārya:

214 “Console My mother and comfort the devotees. If You lose heart, no one will survive.”

215 Saying this, the Lord embraced Him, made Him turn back, and went on His way unhindered.

216 With His four companions the Lord set out for Nīlādri along the bank of the Gaṅgā, by the road through Chatrabhoga.[64]

217 In the *Caitanya-maṅgala* Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in detail the Lord’s journey to Nīlādri.[65]

218 Whoever hears of the Lord’s pastimes in Advaita’s house soon attains the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

219 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[66]

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *bhramāt* — the Lord shows bewilderment to worldly eyes, revealing that Kṛṣṇa’s abode, seen only by eyes of bhakti anointed with the salve of prema, cannot be reached by worldly effort. Heading in the edition: “Obeisance to Gaura, who wandered just after taking sannyāsa”. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
3. The same verse as Madhya 1.16; translation as there. ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the name Rāḍha comes from *rāṣṭra*; the land of Gauḍa on the western bank of the Gaṅgā is called Rāḍha-deśa, also Pauṇḍra-deśa. ↩

5. The song of the mendicant brāhmaṇa of Avantī. *Anubhāṣya*: devotion to the Supreme Self is the natural bhajana that follows when all *anarthas* are gone; the dress of the fourth āśrama belongs to the outward marks of a Vaiṣṇava, and those who wear it are freed from saṁsāra by serving Mukunda. The Lord sang this song of the *tridaṇḍi* mendicant to show that His single *daṇḍa* held all four. ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the meaning of the sannyāsa dress is devotion to the Supreme Self, which rejects attachment to the material self. ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: *prabandha* — a well-composed story. ↩
8. Heading in the edition: “At Nitāi’s word they show the Lord the way to Navadvīpa”. ↩
9. Heading in the edition: Nitāi sends Candraśekhara to Śāntipura so that everything needed may be arranged and the news of the Lord’s coming spread everywhere. ↩
10. The edition reads *āra bhakta-gaṇa* (“and the other devotees”); another reading is *saba bhakta-gaṇa* (“all the devotees”). ↩
11. Heading in the edition: “The Gaṅgā awakens in Mahāprabhu the remembrance of the Yamunā”. ↩
12. Heading in the edition: the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*, quoted in the *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* (5.13). *Anubhāṣya*: *cid-ānanda-bhānu* — Kṛṣṇa, who reveals knowledge and love (*saṁvit* and *prīti*); *drava-brahma-gātrī* — whose form is spiritual water; *aghānām* — of offences; the body is purified by divine knowledge. ↩
13. Heading in the edition: “Seeing Advaita, the Lord hesitates”. ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: *gaṅgāke* (“to the Gaṅgā”) — a form of the speech of Rāḍha, where the author lived before taking sannyāsa: there the locative ending *-e* is still replaced by *-ke*. ↩
15. Heading in the edition: fearing the Lord might refuse, Advaita describes the meal at His house as the simplest fare. ↩
16. Heading in the edition: “Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī cooks, and the Ācārya Himself offers the bhoga”. ↩
17. Heading in the edition: the offering is set out on three plates — for three: the two Lords and Kṛṣṇa. ↩
18. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *āṭhiyā* is a kind of banana tree that bears a bunch of thirty-two clusters; *āṅgaṭiyā* — a whole, untorn banana leaf. ↩
19. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition prints *sādraka* — a dropped *repha* (a printing defect); the reading *sārdraka* is kept. ↩

20. *Cai* — the pungent stems of a pepper vine; *sukhta* — a bitter Bengali vegetable dish. ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya*: *loke* — in the world. ↩
22. *Anubhāṣya*: *iṣṭa* — needed, desired. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: in verses 45–55 the author shows his fine knowledge of the art of cooking. ↩
24. Heading in the edition: tulasī on the offering, and with it water for *ācamana*. ↩
25. *Anubhāṣya*: “to Kṛṣṇa Himself” (*sākṣāt kṛṣṇe*) — that is, to Śrīman Mahāprabhu. The two portions on banana leaves had not been offered (*Anubhāṣya* to verse 66). ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: Advaita Himself offered to Kṛṣṇa only the portion on the metal plate; the two portions on banana leaves, meant for Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda, remained unoffered. The Ācārya kept this in mind and did not reveal it to Mahāprabhu. ↩
27. The edition reads *vaisa tumi karite bhojana* (“You sit down and eat”); another reading is *tine kariye bhojana* (“let the three of us eat”). ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: seeing how much food there was, the Lord asked for two more plates with only a little rice and vegetables on them. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: *upakaraṇa* — dāl, vegetables and the like, which make rice easy to eat. A sannyāsī has no right to such tasty dishes: enjoying what pleases the senses strengthens the urge to enjoy. So the Lord told Raghunātha dāsa, “Do not eat fine food and do not wear fine clothes” (Antya 6.236). ↩
30. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhāribhuri* — a secret. ↩
31. The edition reads *rahibeka āra* (“the rest will remain”); another reading is *pāte rahibeka* (“will remain on the leaf”). ↩
32. *Anubhāṣya*: a sannyāsī may not leave remnants on his plate — Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.18.19: “…and let him eat all that remains, leaving nothing.” ↩
33. The edition reads *taithika* (so also the *Anubhāṣya*); another reading is *tairthika*. *Anubhāṣya*: Nityānanda, though Himself an *avadhūta*, plays the part of a *bahūdaka* sannyāsī who wanders to the holy places. ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya*: *bhraṣṭa* — “fallen” in the eyes of the worldly society of the smārtas, that is, beyond rules and prohibitions: praise in the guise of blame. All these words of Advaita are a joke. The highest stage of sannyāsa is that of the *paramahaṁsa*, also called *avadhūta*. ↩
35. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: a *mān* is a measure of four *sers*. ↩
36. Heading in the edition: the remnants thrown by Nitāi touched Advaita’s body, and Advaita danced, overflowing with love. ↩

37. *Anubhāṣya*: by the rules of the smārtas Advaita should have become impure at the touch of these remnants, but in truth He became supremely pure: the remnants of a Vaiṣṇava, a *paramahaṁsa*, are *mahā-mahā-prasāda*. *Avadhūta* — one who does not care for his body. ↩
38. Heading in the edition: “In the guise of blame Advaita glorifies Nityānanda”. *Anubhāṣya*: “mad by nature” — devoted to the dharma of the *paramahaṁsas*, which is natural to the soul, and every moment intoxicated with serving Kṛṣṇa with all the senses. ↩
39. *Anubhāṣya*: “like You” — a perfected Vaiṣṇava, a *paramahaṁsa* beyond rules and prohibitions; such souls are never ruled by fear of the worldly smārta society. ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya*: to see *mahā-prasāda* as ordinary rice and dāl is an offence (*Bṛhad-viṣṇu-purāṇa*). ↩
41. Heading in the edition: “A Vaiṣṇava’s sannyāsa sets aside the rules of the smārtas”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *smṛti-dharma* — the dharma of the smārtas. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord, a sannyāsī, saw that He was given a fine bed, cloves, cardamom, sandalwood paste and a garland, and that Advaita even wished to massage His feet; so He said, “You have made Me dance a great deal.” ↩
43. The edition reads *loka saba* (“all the people”); another reading is *loka harṣe* (“the people in joy”). *Anubhāṣya*: *samādhāna* — counting. ↩
44. Above the verse the edition prints “A song — [rāga Dhānaśrī]”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ora* — limit; the song is by Vidyāpati. The *Anubhāṣya* quotes the whole song and remarks that it suits the union (*sambhoga*) that follows the separation when Kṛṣṇa was in Mathurā; to take “Mādhava” here for Mādhavendra Purī and the song for Advaita’s own is mistaken. *Cira-dina* is rendered “at long last” in keeping with this reading. ↩
45. *Gāoyāiyā* is causative: “having (others) sing”. ↩
46. Heading in the edition: “The Lord’s separation from Kṛṣṇa”. ↩
47. *Ki nā haila more* — literally “what has not befallen Me!” *Anubhāṣya*: in a song of union (*sambhoga*) the Lord, not finding Kṛṣṇa beside Him, fully revealed the rasa of separation (*vipralambha*); seeing this, Mukunda began a fitting song, and Advaita Prabhu stopped dancing. Vidyāpati has a similar song: “What shall I do, where shall I go? I find no peace.” ↩
48. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*): *harṣa* is the gladness of heart that comes from seeing or gaining what one longs for; *garva* is disregard for others born of one’s good fortune, beauty, youth, virtues, exalted shelter or the attainment of what one desired. ↩

49. Ācāryaratna — Candraśekhara (see v. 20). ↩
50. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *āi* — *āryā*, the honoured lady, that is, Śacīmātā. ↩
51. Heading in the edition: “A devotee’s joy at the sight of the Lord is not a wish to please his own senses”. ↩
52. Heading in the edition: “Advaita’s house is Vaikuṇṭha: there Hari is served at every moment”. ↩
53. The edition reads *āilā*; another reading is *āila*; the sense is the same. ↩
54. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*): “every bhāva” means the eight *sāttvika* transformations — stupor, sweat, hair standing on end, a breaking voice, trembling, pallor, tears and *pralaya*; *pralaya* is the cessation of action and awareness through joy or through sorrow, and its sign is falling to the ground. ↩
55. *Anubhāṣya*: “since my childhood” — from her very infancy. Śacīmātā is eternally perfect, *vātsalya* embodied, by nature Yaśodā herself; devoted to Kṛṣṇa’s service from birth, she was never an ordinary jīva, and here this is told from her own lips. ↩
56. Heading in the edition: “It is not a sannyāsī’s duty to be a *vāntāśī* — ‘one who eats what he has vomited’”. ↩
57. Heading in the edition: “So that Mahāprabhu may not be blamed for false renunciation (*phalgu-vairāgya*), He asks the devotees for counsel”. ↩
58. *Anubhāṣya*: if her son gave up his search for Kṛṣṇa and stayed at home, a mother would be pleased; but the son would be blamed for abandoning Kṛṣṇa’s service, and a truly loving mother would only grieve. Her real happiness lies not in the joy of seeing her son but in his serving Kṛṣṇa; with these words Śacī, the Mother of the world, taught all mothers (cf. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.5.18). ↩
59. *Anubhāṣya*: this verse beautifully explains service: to serve is to wish for the pleasure of Kṛṣṇa’s senses (cf. Ādi 4.174–175, 201, 204; Madhya 4.186; and Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura’s song “Sevā-sukha-duḥkha — parama sampad” in *Śaraṇāgati*). ↩
60. *Anubhāṣya*: Haridāsa Ṭhākura was born in a yavana family but attained brāhmaṇahood by initiation. In his natural humility he told the Lord that by birth he had no right to enter Nīlācala: only people of the four varṇas may enter the courtyard of the Śrī Mandira. Later, learning that nothing prevented him from living on the sands near Nīlādri, he settled there; the place is now known as the Siddha-bakula Maṭha. ↩
61. Heading in the edition: “Spurning the smārta society averse to Hari, the Lord promises to take to Purī Ṭhākura Haridāsa, the transcendental guru of

brāhmaṇas and a Vaiṣṇava ācārya". ↩

62. The edition reads *prabhura āgamane* ("with the Lord's coming"); another reading is *prabhura ārādhane* ("in the worship of the Lord"). ↩
63. *Anubhāṣya*: *nirapekṣa* — free of all dependence on matter and the material, established in one's own nature, the service of Bhagavān. Fearing that an obstacle might arise in His search for Kṛṣṇa, the Lord left on hearing His kinsmen weep and was thought heartless by worldly moralists; but as the world's teacher He showed that the one thing needful for the jīva is the service of Kṛṣṇa, and that even good morality, if it opposes that service, is a path contrary to Caitanya (cf. Antya 3.23). ↩
64. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Lord went along the Gaṅgā through Āṭisārā, Pānihāṭi and Varāhanagara. At that time the Gaṅgā south of Calcutta flowed past Kālīghāṭa and Bāruipura and through the Mathurāpura police station into the ocean in a hundred streams; there, at a place called Ambuliṅga, lay the road through Chatrabhoga. *Anubhāṣya*: the village of Chatrabhoga (also called Khāḍi) lies south of Jayanagara in the 24 Parganas district; the Gaṅgā no longer flows there; see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya 2. ↩
65. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). *Anubhāṣya*: on the way to Nīlācala the Lord passed in Bengal through Āṭisārā, Varāhanagara and Ambuliṅga-Chatrabhoga, and in Utkala through Prayāga-ghāṭa, Suvarṇarekhā, Jaleśvara, Remuṇā, Yājapura, Vaitaraṇī, Daśāśvamedha-ghāṭa, Kaṭaka, Mahānadī, Bhuvaneśvara (Bindu-sarovara), Kamalapura, Āṭhāranālā and other places. ↩
66. The same verse as Ādi 7.171 and Madhya 1.287; translation as there. ↩